

HackSoc Annual General Meeting

Minutes for 2020-05-14

Present: AO (Chair), AD, ArH, AK, BW, DZ, ES, HM, HL, JG, JF, JM, KK, LC, LP, MM, MS, ML, NB, NM, PT, PF, ReH, RR, RyH, SK, TD, ZG

Also present: AsH

Announcements

1. Daniel Cordell appointed to chair the meeting
2. Remote voting process

Described at hacksocnotts.co.uk/election/about

Reports

HackSoc Year in Review - Aaron Osher

1. Year-on-year Revenue is £25,000 with the society spending £18,000
margins accounted for £8,500 in revenue, and spent £4,000
HackNotts 2020 accounted for £12,500 in revenue, and spent £11,000
HHEU Unconference accounted for £2,500 in revenue and expenditure
2. HackNotts 2020 had over 150 hackers, 25 staff, and 20 sponsor reps, and judges
The event has continued the trend of exceeding past years, and the revamp to the organisational structure for 2020, has put the event on target to do the same
3. Bruce Bernard II, the giant teddy-bear, has greatly improved our social media presence in the UK hacker scene
The bear has also attended four hackathons on two continents
4. We met our goal of running at least 2 events per week throughout the year
We initially found ourselves battling some welfare related issues, and streamlined our events process in December to resolve this
5. Member engagement has generally been up over the last year
We don't keep records, but we've also noticed generally a more diverse range of attendees at events over last year
6. Weekend workshops replacing series has worked incredibly well
Moving our multi-week series to weekend events has resulted in better attendance numbers, and more engaged attendees
7. We've continued to maintain our relationship with Tech Nottingham

8. Speaker events

We brought in 20 external speakers this year, a substantial increase over the 12 we had in 2019

Our multi-speaker events were huge successes

9. External Hackathons

In January we started going to Hackathons as a society for the first time in years

We've smashed attendee numbers at events like CovHack, making up 20% of the event's attendees

We've also subsidised hired transport for the first time to support the significant engagement

Old Business

1. Setting of 2020/21 membership fee

Not motioned during the meeting, will resolve at EGM

Constitution Amendments

1. An Update of the partner secretary role as proposed by Samuel King - [hacksocnotts/constitution#44](#)

Role will be more focused on general liaison with industry speakers and partners

Questions

AD: Is this to benefit the society or just tailor it to what you want to do?

SK: Feels it will benefit the society as a whole and it will provide new ways to reach out and get support from industry, as he has quite a log of partners

Voting Result: Passed

For: 22

Against: 1

Abstain: 5

2. Byelaw compliance update proposed by Aaron Osher - [hacksocnotts/constitution#45](#)

Procedural amendment to update to match SU structures

President has been set to chair, and updated an erroneous reference to the societies officer to the activities officer

Various typo corrections

Voting Result: Passed

For: 23

Against: 0

Abstain: 6

3. Replace social media and communications officer with separate social media and marketing secretaries proposed by Aaron Osher - [hacksocnotts/constitution#46](#)

Separate out Marketing will handle newsletters, mailing lists, website, SU and similar;
Social media will handle twitter, engagement, and similar

Voting Result: Passed

For: 21

Against: 5

Abstain: 3

Hustings

Vice President

1. *Alexander Dewfall*

The role being originally defined around him and his work with HackNotts (HN)

Was originally required as Alexi joined as HN organiser

Experience and Skills from working with streamfleet which has given organisational skills

Works with tight timelines with event cadence involved, proved he can do the role

2. *Raj Gohire*

Not present - no presentation for VP Role provided

Questions — None Asked

President

1. *Aaron Osher*

Originally looking to revamping events, making things regular to increase engagement

Struggled around an outgoing committee of 9 people, handover is yet to become a smooth process

Questions — None Asked

Treasurer

1. *Raj Gohire*

Has experience enough to handle the responsibilities and duties

Has 2 years of experience of the role, working with 2 clubs

Doubled previous profits of clubs

Quick learner, and able to handle unforeseen circumstances

With Coronavirus, some companies may be more open to sponsorships to branch out in these trying times

Funding may be difficult due to lack of support, so should prioritise essential events

2. *Neve Marpole*

No specific experience as a treasurer, but feels she has the qualities and is willing to learn

HackSoc has a big budget, so she feels she can manage it responsibly

Wants to look into expenditure and sponsorships

Questions —

1. *AD*: How good are you at picking up new tools?

NM:

Can pick up tools pretty easily, as on compsci course

Has experience from previous jobs, with various systems

RG:

Not present

2. *JM*: Can you say no to Aaron?

NM: Can say no to Aaron

RG: Not present

General Secretary

1. *Reece Roberts*

Provide events of interest and engaging to society members

Wants to aid travel to Hackathons

Continue to aid organisation of talks, workshops and events

Was a SU events officer this past year

Feels will be great for general administration

Questions —

1. *AD*: Can you handle reverse delegation of Aaron?

RR:

Feels he can say no, and would put things to democratic votes

Development Secretary

1. *Danielius Zurllys*

Ready to perform required tasks around hacksoc, such as website admin

Has some workshop Ideas - Python, Kotlin workshops

Game development using Python and OpenGL

2. *Lee Myeongwoo*

Increase easier and harder topic workshops, referenced flattening a bell curve of workshop difficulty

Create more programming workshops and cover more bases

3. *Peter Taylor*

Continue the maintenance of HackSoc
Create more variety with workshops aimed at beginners and advanced
Create a series of workshops “You’ve written your code, what now?”
Services, Servers, the more sysadmin side of development
Help students get their work into the open source community
Continue the Programming Cafes
Showcase society member’s work

Questions —

1. *SK*: How will you make documentation fun?

PT:

Emojis

Question was dismissed as it was specific to one candidate

2. *MM*: To all Devsec Applicants, what events this year have you liked, and what do you think could be improved about them?

DZ:

Enjoyed Saturday events, with python and Kotlin, Cover it on multiple events, to separate out big topics

ML:

Bad Code Hackathon, expand it out to be bad AI hackathon?

PT:

Events all in a room together, working on our own stuff together, it would be nice to have more

Cyber Security Secretary

1. *Luka Corliss*

Keep a lot of the things that worked such as weekly sessions, QA
Help members stage talks
Provide resources to increase their knowledge in cybersec

2. *Ryan Hardwick*

Feels there’s a high barrier to entry on the CyberSec
Help attendees learn skills via TryHackMe
Workshops to secure websites

3. *Zac Garby*

Give a better understanding of cybersec to members
Stop using HackTheBox
Could try JuiceShop
Organise local CTF challenges

Questions — None recorded

Speaker Acquisition Secretary

1. *Jacob Garby*

Past talks have been great, not changing too much

Add a method for people to vote for their favourite topic/speaker

2. *Natasha Bayliss*

Have a lot of experience communicating with groups from previous jobs

Is going on an internship with industry experts, would like to use those connections

Use the suggestions box, push for member choice

Questions —

1. *SK*: How would you balance your time as Speaker Sec?

JG:

Try his best to keep the speakers frequent

Put off speakers if time management gets tough

NB:

Has experience balancing time

Make sure neither is affected by the other

Plan ahead

2. *DC*: What areas would you look at to find speakers?

JG:

Hackspace in Nottingham and TechNottingham

NB:

No recorded response

Welfare and Inclusivity Secretary

1. *Molly Shalliker*

Has been involved with 2 other committees officially, more unofficially

Has previous experience with being welcoming, personable and kind

Has knowledge of the mental health systems at UoN

Is already involved with HackSoc

Questions —

1. *AO*: What would you do to improve inclusivity?

MS:

Feels it comes down to make sure people feel ok to approach

Feels you can lose track of stuff and power on

Emphasise we're approachable

Inclusivity is fluffy term, people need to feel welcome and safe and accepted

Industrial Partners Secretary1. *Samuel King*

Felt it would be good to as placement would make being there an issue

Role in hacksoc, but more towards partnership with industry

Break into new scenes - Birmingham/London have active tech scenes not dissimilar from notts

Organise sponsorship - sell advertising spaces

Has ideas for potential partners to the society

Questions — None asked

Marketing Secretary1. *Reece Roberts*

Will keep the mailing list updated

Keep current members informed and expand to new members

Questions —

1. *DC*: How do you plan to keep to deadlines regarding the role?

RR:

Has taken a lot of extra roles in uni before, so can handle that

Social Media Secretary1. *James Frost*

He has a high level of attention to detail

He includes all required info in comms

Holds a similar role in Anime Society

Wants to have clear communication of upcoming topics

2. *Archie Hilton*

Feels it's not much to do

Feels it's an easy job to do

Keep members and potential members up to date with pictures

3. *Ashleigh Haxie*

Has quite a bit of experience with Bruce the Bear

Is going onto organiser staff for HackNotts 2020, so feels it's a logical step

Wants to help the society in whatever way she can

Likes the friendly banter on social media platforms, wants to get HackSoc involved

Feels the brand currently is inconsistent, wants to get it back to standard and reliable

Questions —

1. *AD*: What are your plans for Bruce?

JF:

Include him in many posts, to provide more character

ArH:

Bruce should be on all posts

AsH:

Has represented Bruce at hackathons and online in the past, so feels she can get the community behind her on that

Wants to have Bruce show up on media with HackSoc often

Graphics Officer

1. *Reece Harvey*

Changing things year on year is bad

Keep the strong brand

Get out consistent images and graphics for the brand

Questions —

1. *AD*: How much of a portfolio in graphics do you have?

ReH:

An A* in graphics design GCSE

Election Results

1. President

Round 1: Aaron Osher won with 27 of 27 votes

Winner: Aaron Osher

2. Vice President

Round 1: Alexander Dewfall won with 26 of 27 votes

Winner: Alexander Dewfall

3. Treasurer

Round 1: Neve Marpole won with 17 of 26 votes

Winner: Neve Marpole

4. General Secretary

Round 1: Reece Roberts won with 25 of 27 votes

Winner: Reece Roberts

5. Development Secretary

Round 1: Peter Taylor won with 17 of 26 votes

Winner: Peter Taylor

6. Cyber-Security Secretary

Round 1: Luka Corliss was eliminated with 4 of 26 votes

Round 2: Ryan Hardwick won with 15 of 26 votes

Winner: Ryan Hardwick

7. Speaker Acquisition Secretary

Round 1: Natasha Bayliss won with 21 of 27 votes

Winner: Natasha Bayliss

8. Welfare and Inclusivity Secretary

Round 1: Molly Shalliker won with 27 of 27 votes

Winner: Molly Shalliker

9. Industrial Partners Secretary

Round 1: Samuel King won with 25 of 27 votes

Winner: Samuel King

10. Marketing Secretary

Round 1: Reece Roberts won with 23 of 27 votes

Winner: Reece Roberts

11. Social Media Secretary

Round 1: James Frost was eliminated with 4 of 17 votes

Round 2: Ashleigh Haxie won with 11 of 17 votes

Winner: Ashleigh Haxie¹

12. Graphics Officer

Round 1: Reece Harvey won with 27 of 27 votes

Winner: Reece Harvey

Next Meeting: EGM to be held after Exams - Date TBA

¹Result does not stand due to membership status and post will be filled by byelection at pending EGM

Attendance***Full Members - Voting***

1. (AO) Aaron Osher - 14340664
2. (AD) Alexander Dewfall - 14304576
3. (ArH) Archie Hilton - 20158257
4. (AK) Aryan Kankaria - 20211766
5. (BW) Bonnie Wu - 20190016
6. (DZ) Danielius Zurlys - 20130611
7. (ES) Edward Smith - 20179417
8. (HM) Hani Momeninia - 14324838
9. (HL) Hannah Lester - 14328501
10. (JG) Jacob Garby - 20180775
11. (JF) James Frost - 20132566
12. (JM) John Mercer - 14276214
13. (KK) Keval Kapdee - 20156426
14. (LC) Luka Corliss - 20180247
15. (MM) Mia Mukherjee - 14272571
16. (MS) Molly Shalliker - 10047981
17. (ML) Myeongwoo Lee - 14337568
18. (NB) Natasha Bayliss - 20145495
19. (NM) Neve Marpole - 14323885
20. (PT) Peter Taylor - 20131035
21. (PF) Primoz Fabiani - 14306763
22. (ReH) Reece Harvey - 14325970
23. (RR) Reece Roberts - 14324016
24. (RyH) Ryan Hardwick - 20161866
25. (SK) Samuel King - 14322391
26. (TD) Tara Dilley - 14304226
27. (ZG) Zac Garby - 20176069

Associate Members - Voting

1. (LP) Leanne Payne

Non- Voting

1. (AsH) Ashleigh Haxie
Taking minutes